IELTS Space
by THE IELTS SPACE

REPORT 1 · VISION & SCOPE

IELTSPath

An IELTS practice system for IELTS Space learners, supporting classroom lessons and the wait for the next band class

Team: SEP490_G112 · Version v1.1.0 · 9 Oct 2026

Learners need a place to practice outside class hours

IELTS Space is an IELTS test-prep center in Hanoi that teaches in classes grouped by band. The main learning happens in class; outside class, learners practice on their own with no tool that matches what the center teaches.

Learners currently enrolled

Between lessons they practice with handouts from the teacher or free websites. Their work is not graded right away, and they do not know what knowledge gap caused a mistake.

Learners waiting for a new band class

They finish one band and wait for the next band class to open. During the wait there is almost nothing to practice, so they easily stop studying.

Same goal, different starting points

Two learners both aim for 7.0: one at 5.0 needs to firm up the basics, one at 6.5 needs advanced practice. Learners need to know where they are weak so they can review the right things.

Linh practices without direction, Minh stops practicing while waiting for a class

Linh

Second-year student · in a band 5.5 class · target 6.5

- Between lessons, does center handouts and a few online tests
- Sees scores, but not which Reading skill keeps costing points
- Does not know what to review before the next lesson
- Online tests do not match the band and content of the current class

Minh

Office worker · finished the 5.5 class · waiting for the 6.0 class

- While waiting for the new class, has nothing to practice
- Wants to get familiar with band 6.0 content but has no materials
- Loses practice momentum and must restart when the new class begins
- Only free in the evening, needs short exercises that fit in one evening

Learners already practice online; the question is where

What learners are losing

- Practice time is not aimed at real weak points
- They do not know what knowledge gap caused a mistake or what to review next
- Waiting for a class makes them stop practicing and lose momentum

Why current tools fall short

- Handouts: not graded right away, no explanations
- Free websites: do not match the band and class content
- Nothing to practice while waiting for a class

Direction and constraints

Learners still practice online, but on generic websites that do not match what the current class covers. The center needs its own channel that follows exactly what it teaches.

The system serves only the center's learners. Premium content access is granted through activation cards issued by the sales team; no payment or accounting is added.

Three ways to practice today, none is enough

Criteria	STUDY4	ELSA Speak	Self-study at IELTS Space today
Audience	Vietnamese IELTS test-takers, from building foundations to targeting high bands	People who want to improve speaking; offers an IELTS Speaking course	Learners currently enrolled and learners waiting for a new band class
Features	4-skill courses; practice tests per skill with materials	Pronunciation and fluency feedback through speech recognition; AI conversations; personalized path; games	Teachers hand out practice materials between lessons
Strengths	Many practice tests; familiar question types and exam format	Many chances to speak, fast feedback	Materials written by the center's teachers, matching class content
Limitations	Shows only the score and number of correct answers; no explanation of why an answer is wrong or what to study next; leans toward test practice over building knowledge	Focused on speaking; no IELTS path combining Reading, Listening and Writing with practice tests	No instant grading or feedback; learners do not know which knowledge they are weak at; nothing to practice while waiting for a class

Sources: study4.com · vn.elsaspeak.com · IELTS Space's current process

Three current solutions leave seven gaps

GAP-01 · Not knowing why an answer is wrong · STUDY4

Results show only a score, not which knowledge is missing or what to review next.

GAP-02 · Practicing tests before learning the knowledge · STUDY4

Learners jump into tests before mastering the knowledge the question type requires.

GAP-03 · Only speaking can be practiced · ELSA

ELSA gives feedback on speaking only. There is no place to practice all 4 skills.

GAP-04 · Not knowing where they are weak · Self-study at the center

Self-study does not tell learners which topics they have mastered or which knowledge points are still weak.

GAP-05 · No practice content outside class hours · Self-study at the center

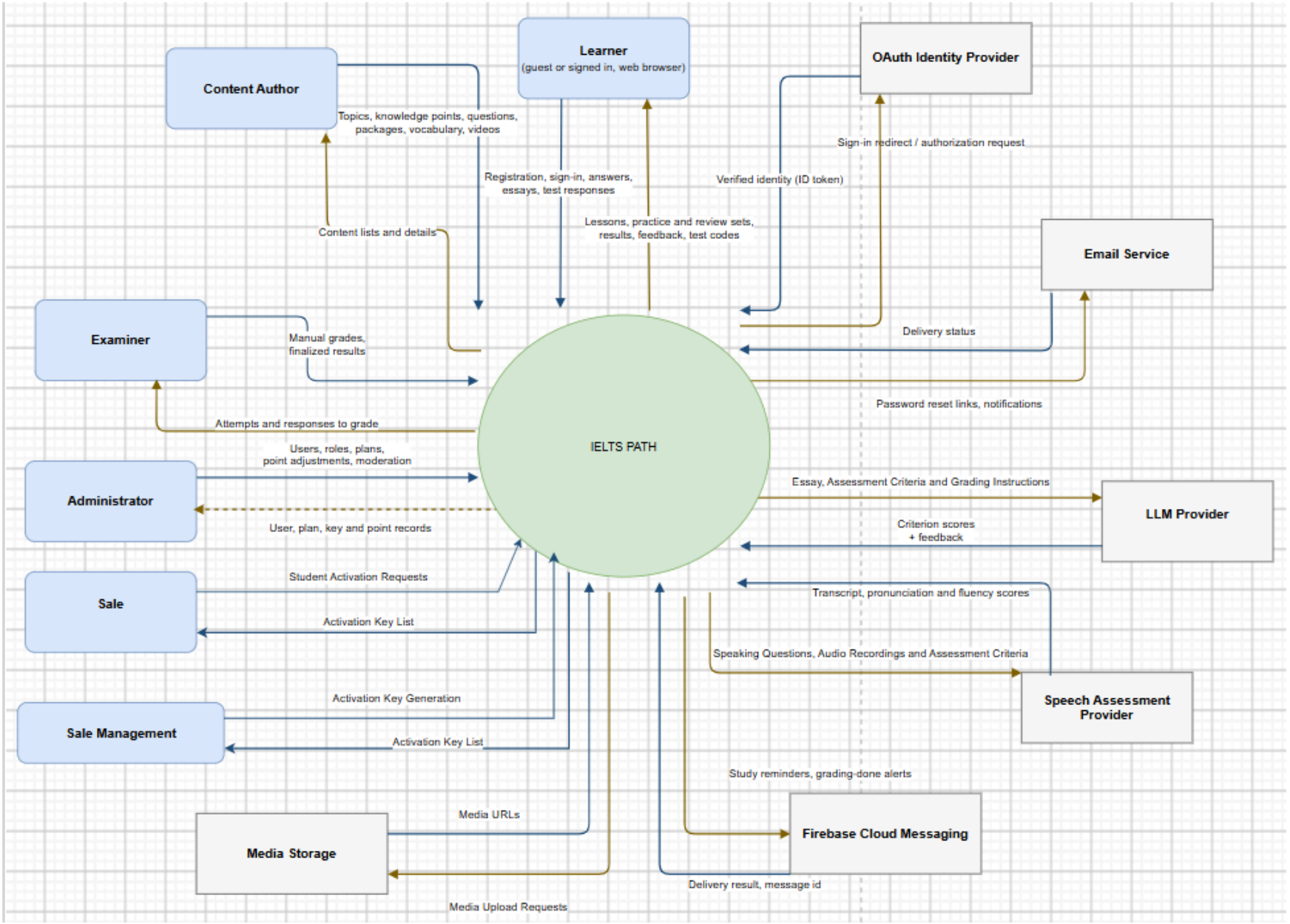
Between lessons and while waiting for a new class, learners have no online content that matches the center's band.

GAP-06 · Lack of motivation to practice · Self-study at the center

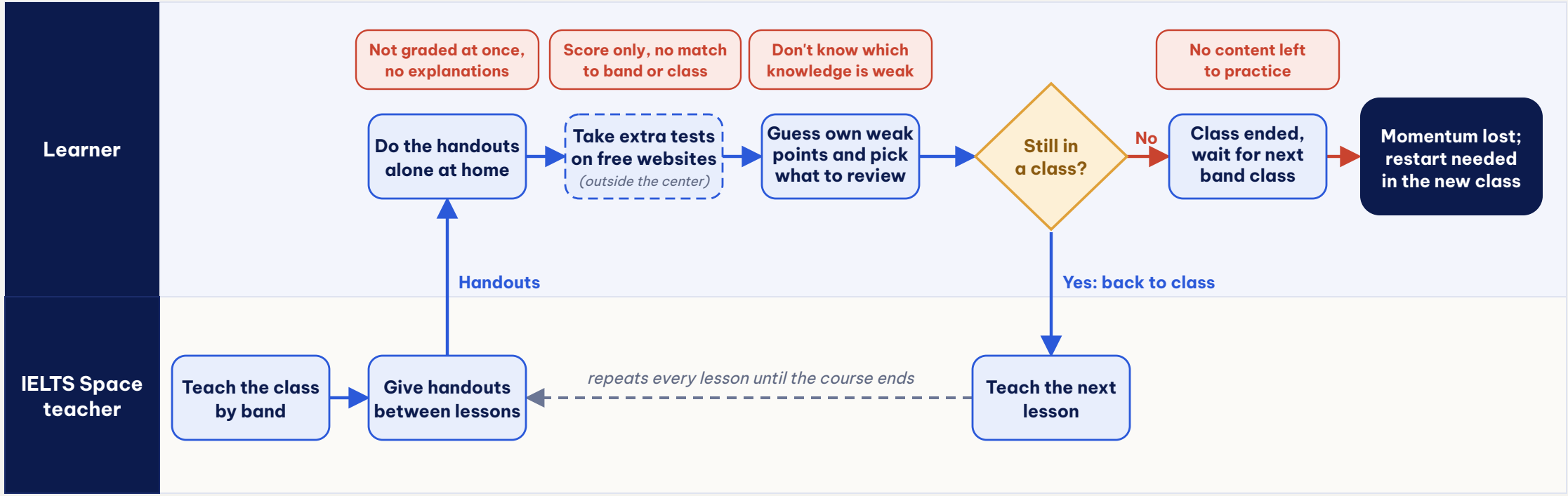
Practicing alone is discouraging; there is no community or activity to bring learners back.

GAP-07 · Vocabulary learned without context · Self-study at the center

Words are learned from lists, without usage context and without regular review.


Learner
(guest or signed in, web browser)
Content Author
OAuth Identity Provider
Topics, knowledge points, questions, packages, vocabulary, videos
Sign-in redirect / authorization request
Registration, sign-in, answers, essays, test responses
Verified identity (ID token)
Content lists and details
Lessons, practice and review sets, results, feedback, test codes
Email Service
Examiner
Manual grades, finalized results
Delivery status
Password reset links, notifications
Attempts and responses to grade
IELTS PATH
Users, roles, plans, point adjustments, moderation
Administrator
Essay, Assessment Criteria and Grading Instructions
LLM Provider
User, plan, key and point records
Criterion scores + feedback
Student Activation Requests
Sale
Transcript, pronunciation and fluency scores
Activation Key List
Speaking Questions, Audio Recordings and Assessment Criteria
Speech Assessment Provider
Activation Key Generation
Sale Management
Activation Key List
Study reminders, grading-done alerts
Media URLs
Media Storage
Firebase Cloud Messaging
Delivery result, message id
Media Upload Requests

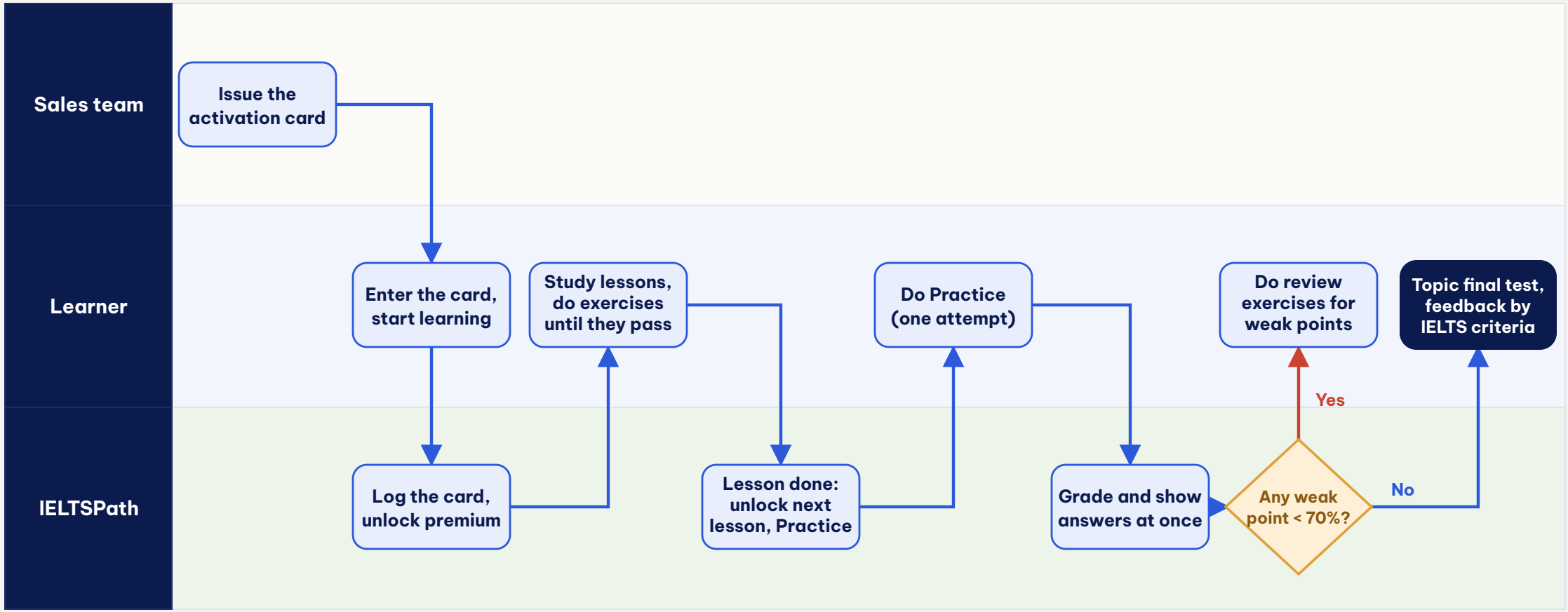
How learners self-study at IELTS Space today



Red text: learner pain points Dashed: a tool outside the center, treated as a black box Loop repeated every lesson

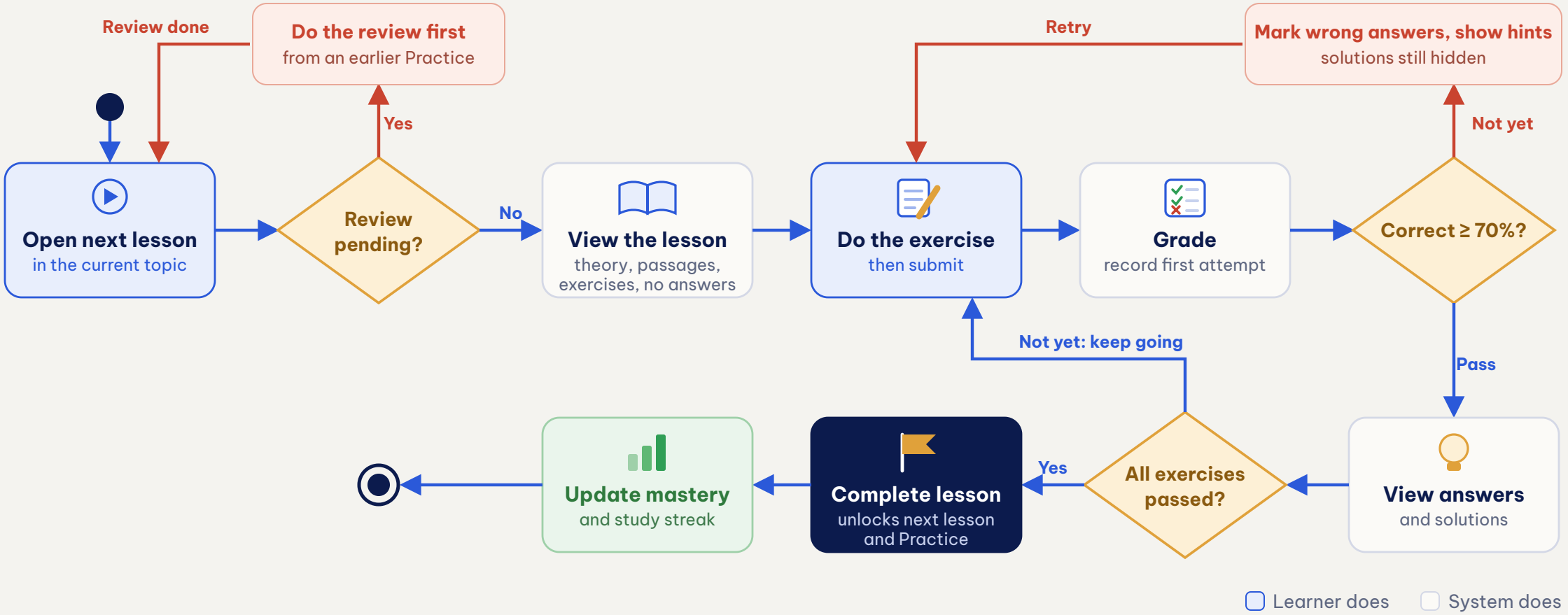
SOLUTION · TO-BE

Learners practice with IELTSPath

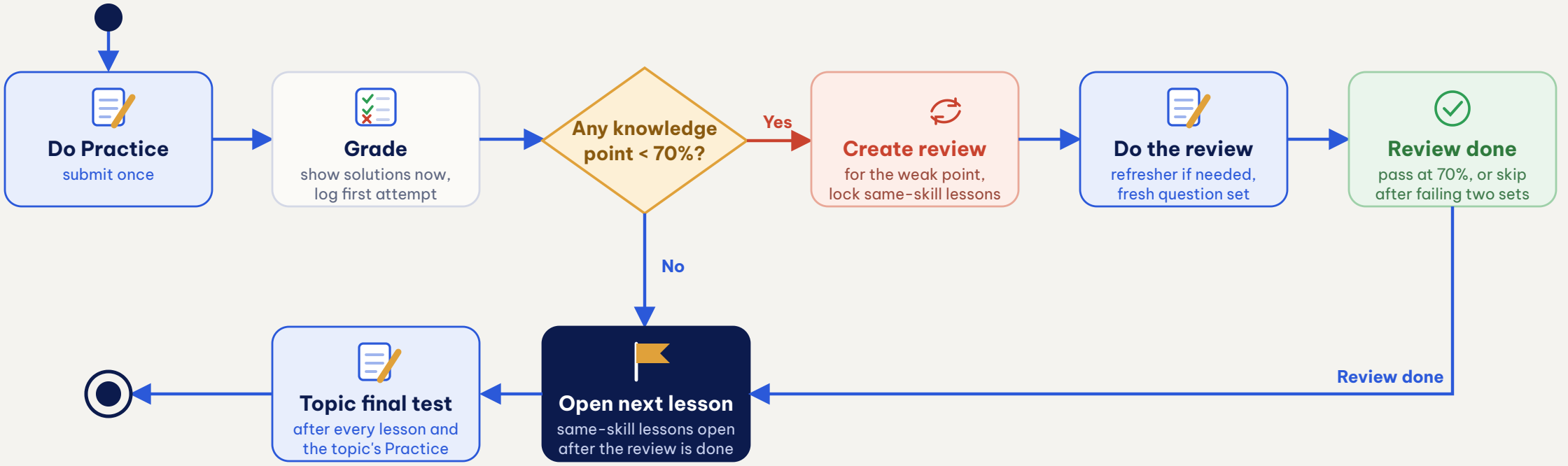


Red text: review branch for weak knowledge points

Learning one lesson: pass the exercises to move on



Practice: if wrong, review the weak point first



How the mastery of a knowledge point is calculated

1 Every answer is a piece of evidence

The first attempt at each question in exercises, Practice, review, Writing and tests is recorded as correct or wrong for the knowledge point the question teaches. Retries are not recorded again.

2 Only the 5 most recent answers count

Newer answers weigh more than older ones. Weights from oldest to newest: 0.5 · 0.7 · 0.85 · 0.95 · 1.0. The newest answer always weighs the most.

3 Little evidence means little trust

With only 1 answer: capped at 0.5. With 2 answers: capped at 0.8. From 3 answers up: capped at 1.0.

EXAMPLE: LAST 4 ANSWERS

Mastery = sum of weights of correct answers ÷ sum of weights of all answers

✓	✓	✗	✓
oldest			newest
× 0.7	**× 0.85**	**× 0.95**	**× 1.0**

(0.7 + 0.85 + 1.0) ÷ (0.7 + 0.85 + 0.95 + 1.0) = 2.55 ÷ 3.5



0.73

Learners see this level for each knowledge point. After a test, knowledge points below 0.6 generate a review exercise.

IELTSPath: learn the knowledge first, review by each learner's mistakes

01
Placement test
A short placement test estimates the band and suggests a suitable course.

→

02
Learn knowledge first
Each course belongs to one band and contains topics and lessons that teach the knowledge for each question type before practice.

→

03
Practice
Wrong answers are recorded against the knowledge point that is missing.

→

04
Targeted review
Weak knowledge points trigger their own review exercises, so the next step is always specific.

→

05
Feedback and mock tests
Writing and Speaking get feedback against IELTS criteria; a 4-skill mock test shows readiness.

IELTSPath is IELTS Space's online practice channel on the **web**, for learners currently studying at the center and learners waiting for a new band class. The system supplements, and does not replace, classroom lessons.

One practice channel for the two moments learners need it most

Learners currently enrolled

- Revisit class knowledge through lessons and band-based Practice
- Get review exercises targeted at the knowledge points that are still weak
- Get Writing and Speaking feedback against IELTS criteria

Learners waiting for a new band class

- Keep the practice rhythm through games, competitions and a learner community
- Learn vocabulary in the context of videos and review with flashcards

The center's sales team

Issues activation cards to learners who have enrolled so they can unlock premium content. The system only records which card was activated, by which account, and when.

No learner tracking. The system has no reports or dashboards for teachers or the center about what learners practice. Progress and weak points are used only to choose review exercises and for learners to view themselves.

Premium via activation cards: the system only issues cards and keeps a log

System

Create a card batch

Admin creates card codes for each premium plan, for example a batch of 500 cards.

→

Sales and center

Hand the card to the learner

A learner who enrolls in a course at the center receives a card from sales; pricing and payment collection are the center's job.

→

System

Learner enters the code

A valid code unlocks premium content for the account; each card can be used only once.

→

System

Log the activation

Stores which card, which account and when. If there is a question, sales just looks up the log.

What the system does

Creates card codes, activates them, unlocks premium, logs activations. Some topics are open to every account.

What the system does not do

Online payment gateway, invoices, accounting, revenue statistics. Sales and the center handle these.

Band-based path, practice and assessment

Code	Feature	Description
FE-01	**Placement test and course suggestion**	A placement test estimates the band and suggests a course for that band
FE-02	**Band-based courses, multi-skill lessons**	A band course contains topics and lessons with theory and exercises for Reading, Listening and Writing; Speaking is practiced through FE-10
FE-03	**Adaptive practice and review**	Practice results update the mastery of each knowledge point; weak points trigger review sets and a theory refresher
FE-04	**AI Writing feedback**	AI grades essays against the IELTS Writing criteria and lists strengths and areas to improve for each criterion
FE-05	**Topic and course tests, personal progress**	A final test closes each topic and course; learners view their own mastery and progress
FE-10	**Speaking practice with AI feedback**	Record IELTS Speaking answers and practice speaking along with videos; AI scores the speech and returns a transcript with pronunciation and fluency scores
FE-11	**Full IELTS mock test**	Mock test for all 4 skills; Reading and Listening are auto-graded, Writing and Speaking are graded by an examiner

Keeping the practice rhythm outside class hours

Code	Feature	Description
FE-06	**Learning games and competitions**	Real-time vocabulary and grammar games in game rooms; learners compete against each other
FE-07	**Vocabulary via video and flashcards**	Learn words in the context of videos, save video clips, review with flashcard sets and notes
FE-08	**Learner community**	Post questions and study tips, comment and react; posts are moderated
FE-09	**Activation cards for premium content**	Sales issues activation cards to enrolled learners to unlock premium content; the system records who activated a card and when

Why IELTSPath uses microservices

1 Parts with very different load profiles

Real-time competitive games, slow AI essay grading, and learning itself must be fast. Separating them keeps the heavy parts from slowing learning down.

2 The personalization part changes the most

How weak points are scored and review exercises are chosen needs continuous experimentation and upgrades. Separating it lets it change without affecting tests, content or accounts.

3 Each part manages its own data

Content, test results, learning progress and activation cards are changed by different people. Each part keeps its own data with clear boundaries.

4 One failing part does not take down the whole system

If games or the community have an incident, learners can still study; test results are saved and reprocessed, not lost.

In addition, team members work in parallel on separate parts, testing and deploying independently.

What is out of project scope

Code	Out of scope	Reason
LI-01	**Tracking and monitoring learners: teacher dashboards, practice reports for the center**	The system is a self-study tool for learners; learning data is used only to choose review exercises and for learners to view themselves
LI-02	**Trial learning for unregistered visitors, enrollment channel**	The system serves only the center's learners; advising and enrollment remain the center's job
LI-03	**Online payment gateway, invoices, accounting, revenue statistics**	Collecting payment is the job of sales and the center; the system only creates card codes, activates them and logs activations
LI-04	**Direct class operations: timetables, class assignment, attendance, tuition**	IELTS Space already runs these with its own staff and tools
LI-05	**Online classes, lecture videos with teachers**	The system is a self-study channel; lectures with teachers stay in class
LI-06	**Official IELTS certificates or band guarantees**	Mock test results are estimates for practice and do not replace the official IELTS exam
LI-07	**RAG-based IELTS chatbot assistant**	Needs a curated, tested IELTS knowledge base so answers are trustworthy
LI-08	**Use by other centers (multi-center, franchise)**	Built only for IELTS Space; multiple centers would need separate data, branding and administration
LI-09	**Mobile app (iOS / Android)**	The first release focuses on the web; a mobile app comes after the web learning flow is validated with learners

Learners review the right weak spots, the center gains practice hours outside class

For learners

- Review exercises that match the band and what is being taught in class
- Know their weak points and what to review next, with less guessing
- Keep practicing while waiting for a new band class
- Short lessons and practice sets that work on the web
- Writing and Speaking feedback right away, no waiting for the next lesson

For IELTS Space

- Extend learning beyond class hours with the center's own content
- Learners enter the new band class with knowledge already reviewed
- Self-study exercises are auto-graded, adding no grading work for teachers
- Sales can answer card questions straight from the activation log

Satisfaction is measured by a voluntary end-of-course survey run by the center outside the system, not by tracking learners.

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Thank you for listening

Q & A